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EXPANSION AND INTEGRATION

India and Pakistan came close to war after the Parliament attack in December 2001 when the two countries massed troops along their shared border. The Musharraf regime clamped down on cross-LoC infiltration immediately afterwards and banned several militant outfits, including Lashkar, but neither side demobilized and relations between the two remained fraught with tension. Infiltrations resumed and, despite the ban, Pakistan took no steps to dismantle the militant infrastructure on its territory. The Kaluchak massacre in May 2002 threatened to catalyze war, once again leading to a temporary clampdown in infiltrations. Within several weeks of Musharraf's pledge to US Deputy Secretary of State Richard Armitage to halt cross-border terrorism, Indian officials reported an approximately 90 per cent drop in shelling by Pakistani troops in Kashmir and a significant decline in cross-LoC infiltration. This was another tactical pause rather than a strategic shift, and by August infiltrations were rising.[1] Nevertheless, state assembly elections in Indian-administered Kashmir were held in September and October 2002. The successful election process provided New Delhi with an opportunity to pull its troops back and Operation Parakram, launched in the wake of the Parliament attack, was officially called off after the elections. War between India and Pakistan had been averted and relations between the two were normalizing. In late 2003 the two countries agreed to a ceasefire along the LoC and in 2004 they initiated the composite dialogue to address the bilateral issues between them.

According to one Indian analyst close to the security establishment in New Delhi at the time, the Indian government was surprised when Pakistan agreed to the composite dialogue because it meant discussion on terrorism